Inventory Routing

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1 Abstract

The paper presents a multi-start iterated local search for solving the inventory routing problem with logistic ratio. The proposed optimisation algorithm utilise serval components include an application of the Lagrangian relaxation where violation on the stockout constratins is permitted, a devliery quantity reoptimisation procedure, and serval local search operators integrates both routing decision and quantity decision. The computational experiements were conducted on 978 small instances with 5 to 50 customer and 150 large instances with 50 to 200 customers. The results shown the proposed algorithm outperformance all instances on previous available metaheuristics for large instances and produces competitive results on small instances. We also give our attempt on integrating the hybrid genetic search from capacited vehicle routing problem into the proposed multi-started iterated local search. With hybrid genetic search, the solution quality can still be improved by certain percentage.

2 Introduction

The Inventory Routing Problem (IRP) is an extremely challenging optimization problem where the goal is to determine the replenishment and distribution plan for a supply chain network where there is a single supplier and multiple retailers who need to be replenished with the community produced and distributed by the supplier. A planning horizon is defined over which the replenishment activities should take place. Each retailers faces a per period demand over the horizon and has a maximum inventory capacity. The supplier has a fleet of capacitated vehicles which are used for distribution operations. The goal is to define the plan that optimizes a given objective function in such a way that each retailer has a sufficient quantity to satisfy the demand in all periods and the vehicle capacity is not exceeded in any route. More in detail, the plan consists in defining, for each period, which retailers are visited, what is the quantity delivered to each retailer and what are the routes of the vehicles that has to distribute those quantities.

The objective function which is commonly used in the classical IRP consists of the total cost, to be minimized, which is given by the sum of routing cost

plus the inventory cost at the supplier and at the retailers Archetti et al. (2012); Archetti and Speranza (2016). However, it often happens that the inventory cost is hard to define or it is negligible with respect to the routing cost. In this case, other objective functions could be used instead of the total cost. Indeed, a KPI which is often used in practice is the so called *Logistic Ratio* (LR) which consists in the ratio between the routing cost and the total quantity delivered. In this case, we obtain the IRP with LR (IRP-LR).

The IRP-LR finds relevant applications in practice, especially when the transportation cost is the main component of the total cost. In fact, it was first introduced in the 2016 ROADEF Challenge by Air Liquide. It then gained success and attracted relevant research attention Archetti et al. (2017a, 2019); Alvarez et al. (2018). The problem proved to be much more challenging than IRP when it comes to finding effective solution approaches. The goal of the current work is to propose a new heuristic algorithm for the IRP-LR, namely an Iterated Local Search (ILS).

Outline:

- As efficient heuristic search procedures exist for routing decisions, while deciding on delivery quantities may be more naturally done using mathematical programming models, it is common in the literature that the IRP is tackled by some matheuristics Iswari et al. (2026).
- In Castro et al. (2026), a hybrid genetic search is designed for the IRP, where it uses hybrid genetic search Vidal (2022) for the routing component, while the delivery quantities are obtained by solving a minimum-cost flow model using the network simplex algorithm.
- Allow violation. These two papers allow violation of vehicle capacity Castro et al. (2026), Archetti et al. (2012).

In the vast literature of IRP, most solution approaches are mathematical formulation-based, mostly because of the delivery quantity decision. A gap remains for a pure heuristic approach.

We assume that a customer will eventually have a stockout. Customer eventually not having a stockout should be discarded. We also assume that there will be no stockout if a customer is visited every day. Meaning that it is not difficult in obtaining a feasible solution. The challenge is to obtain a solution that minimises the transportation cost while delivering as much as possible.

We also assume sufficient production at the depot to fulfil the demand from all retailers.

Recent methodology development focuses on the objective function to minimise the transportation cost and inventory holding cost. Castro et al. (2026); Zhao et al. (2025)

Main Contributions

- We developed a new constructive heuristic suitable for the IRP-LR. It differs from the one developed in Alvarez et al. (2018).
- We developed a new MSILS with the amalgamation of iterated local search and Lagrangian relaxation as well as a quantity-focused disturbance procedure.
- We also enhance the local search operator with a local rebalance mechanism inspired by the violation-of-vehicle-capacity strategy from the well-known HGS algorithm for CVRP Vidal (2022).
- The complete algorithm demonstrates superior performance compared with the Simulated annealing and iterated local search algorithm developed in Alvarez et al. (2018) on almost every instance. The algorithm performance is more evident on large instances.

3 Problem Background and Related Literature

The Inventory Routing Problem (IRP) integrates inventory replenishment and vehicle-routing decisions over a multi-period planning horizon. Rather than taking delivery quantities as predetermined inputs, the supplier jointly determines when customers are visited, how much product is delivered, and how the corresponding vehicle routes are constructed (Bertazzi and Speranza, 2012; Coelho et al., 2014). This integration can reduce system-wide logistics costs, but it also creates strong dependencies between routing decisions, delivery quantities, and customer inventory levels across periods.

Most classical IRP formulations minimise an absolute measure of routing, inventory, or total logistics cost. Archetti et al. (2017b) introduced an alternative performance measure, referred to as the *logistic ratio*, defined as the routing cost per unit of product delivered. Their motivation arises partly from the finite-horizon effect of conventional IRP objectives. Under total-cost minimisation, there is generally little incentive to deliver additional inventory near the end of the planning horizon if it is consumed only after the horizon. A cost-per-unit-delivered objective explicitly accounts for the amount transported and can therefore mitigate this effect.

For a solution s, let $C(s)$ denote its total routing cost and $Q(s)$ the total quantity delivered. The logistic ratio is

$$LR(s) = \frac{C(s)}{Q(s)}. \tag{1}$$

If $Q(s)$ were constant across all feasible solutions, minimising (1) would be equivalent to minimising routing cost. In an IRP, however, delivery quantities are endogenous. Consequently, the objective simultaneously favours

$$C(s) \downarrow \qquad \text{and} \qquad Q(s) \uparrow,$$

and may therefore generate substantially different replenishment decisions from a conventional cost-minimising IRP.

The problem studied in this paper follows the single-product IRP with logistic ratio (IRP-LR) introduced in Archetti et al. (2017b). The formulation below additionally introduces auxiliary stockout variables, denoted by μ_{it}, which are forced to zero in the original problem and therefore do not modify its feasible solution set. Their purpose is to enable the Lagrangian-relaxation mechanism used later within the proposed solution algorithm.

3.1 Problem Formulation

Let $G = (N, E)$ be a complete undirected graph, where $N = \{0\} \cup N'$ is the set of locations and E is the set of edges. Node 0 represents the depot and $N' = \{c_1, c_2, \ldots, c_{|N'|}\}$ denotes the set of customers. A non-negative routing cost c_{ij} is associated with each edge $\langle i, j\rangle \in E$, and the costs are assumed to satisfy the triangle inequality. The planning horizon $T = \{1, \ldots, |T|\}$ consists of discrete periods. Each customer $i \in N'$ has an inventory capacity U_i and consumes r_{it} units in period $t \in T$. The depot produces r_{0t} units in period t, and I_{i0} denotes the initial inventory at location $i \in N$. A fleet $K = \{k_1, \ldots, k_{|K|}\}$ of homogeneous vehicles is available, each with capacity Q.

The objective is to construct a distribution plan that minimises the logistic ratio while ensuring that vehicle capacities and customer inventory capacities are respected and that no stockout occurs in the original problem. Split deliveries are not permitted: a customer can be served by at most one vehicle in each period. The following decision variables are used:

- $I_{it} \geq 0$: inventory level at location i at the end of period t;
- y_{ij}^{kt}: number of times edge $\langle i, j\rangle$ is traversed by vehicle k in period t;
- $q_{it}^{k} \geq 0$: quantity delivered to customer i by vehicle k in period t;
- $z_{it}^{k} \in \{0, 1\}$: equal to one if location i is visited by vehicle k in period t;
- $\mu_{it} \geq 0$: auxiliary stockout quantity associated with customer i in period t.

For a subset $S \subseteq N'$, define $E(S) = \{\langle i, j\rangle \in E : i, j \in S\}$. Assuming that the total delivered quantity is positive, the IRP-LR is formulated as follows:

$$\min \quad \frac{\sum_{k\in K}\sum_{\langle i,j\rangle\in E}\sum_{t\in T} c_{ij}\, y_{ij}^{kt}}{\sum_{k\in K}\sum_{i\in N'}\sum_{t\in T} q_{it}^{k}} \tag{2}$$

$$\text{s.t.} \quad I_{0t} = I_{0,t-1} + r_{0t} - \sum_{k\in K}\sum_{i\in N'} q_{it}^{k}, \qquad t \in T, \tag{3}$$

$$I_{it} - \mu_{it} = I_{i,t-1} - \mu_{i,t-1} - r_{it} + \sum_{k\in K} q_{it}^{k}, \quad i \in N',\ t \in T, \tag{4}$$

$$I_{it} \geq 0, \qquad i \in N,\ t \in T, \tag{5}$$

$$\mu_{it} \geq 0, \qquad i \in N',\ t \in T, \tag{6}$$

$$\sum_{i\in N'}\sum_{t\in T} \mu_{it} \leq 0, \tag{7}$$

$$\sum_{k\in K} q_{it}^{k} \leq U_i - I_{i,t-1}, \qquad i \in N',\ t \in T, \tag{8}$$

$$q_{it}^{k} \leq U_i z_{it}^{k}, \qquad i \in N',\ k \in K,\ t \in T, \tag{9}$$

$$\sum_{i\in N'} q_{it}^{k} \leq Q z_{0t}^{k}, \qquad k \in K,\ t \in T, \tag{10}$$

$$\sum_{k\in K} z_{it}^{k} \leq 1, \qquad i \in N',\ t \in T, \tag{11}$$

$$\sum_{j:\langle i,j\rangle\in E} y_{ij}^{kt} = 2 z_{it}^{k}, \qquad i \in N,\ k \in K,\ t \in T, \tag{12}$$

$$\sum_{\langle i,j\rangle\in E(S)} y_{ij}^{kt} \leq |S| - 1, \qquad S \subseteq N',\ |S| \geq 2,\ k \in K,\ t \in T, \tag{13}$$

$$z_{it}^{k} \in \{0,1\}, \qquad i \in N,\ k \in K,\ t \in T, \tag{14}$$

$$q_{it}^{k} \geq 0, \qquad i \in N',\ k \in K,\ t \in T, \tag{15}$$

$$y_{ij}^{kt} \in \{0,1,2\}, \qquad \langle i,j\rangle \in E,\ k \in K,\ t \in T. \tag{16}$$

The objective function (2) minimises total routing cost per unit of product delivered. Constraints (3) and (4) impose the inventory balance equations at the depot and customers, respectively. For a customer, $I_{it} - \mu_{it}$ represents its net inventory position. Since both I_{it} and μ_{it} are non-negative, Constraint (7) forces $\mu_{it} = 0$ for every customer and period in the original problem and hence eliminates stockouts.

Constraint (8) prevents deliveries from exceeding the available customer storage capacity, while Constraint (9) allows a positive delivery only if the corresponding customer is visited. Constraint (10) imposes vehicle capacity, and Constraint (11) prevents split deliveries within a period. Constraints (12) and (13) ensure valid vehicle routes. Because the number of subtour-elimination constraints is exponential, Constraint (13) can be generated dynamically when the formulation is solved exactly. Constraints (14)–(16) specify the remaining variable domains.

3.2 Solution Approaches in the Literature

The fractional objective adds an additional layer of difficulty to the already challenging interaction between routing, inventory, and replenishment quantities. The IRP-LR belongs to the broader class of fractional optimisation problems. The classical parametric approach of Dinkelbach (1967) transforms a fractional problem into a sequence of optimisation problems with an objective of the form

$$N(s) - \lambda D(s).$$

This connection has motivated exact approaches for routing problems with decision-dependent ratios.

Following the introduction of the IRP-LR, Archetti et al. (2019) developed an improved exact algorithm that solves the fractional problem through a sequence of IRPs with linear objective functions. Baldacci et al. (2020) subsequently investigated fractional objectives in vehicle routing more generally and developed an exact framework based on specialised primal and dual bounds.

Metaheuristic approaches are particularly relevant for larger instances. Alvarez et al. (2018) proposed Iterated Local Search (ILS) and Simulated Annealing algorithms for the IRP and considered the logistic-ratio objective, providing an important heuristic precedent for the present work. The ROADEF/EURO Challenge 2016 further stimulated several algorithms for a rich industrial inventory routing problem with a unit-distribution-cost objective. These include heuristic branch-cut-and-price (Absi et al., 2020), local search combined with mathematical programming (Su et al., 2020), fixed-sequence reoptimisation (He et al., 2020), and hyper-heuristic search (Kheiri, 2020).

Of particular relevance, He et al. (2020) show that substantial improvements can be obtained by reoptimising delivery quantities and timing while retaining a fixed customer sequence. This distinction between route structure and quantity optimisation is especially important under a logistic-ratio objective because quantities directly affect the denominator of the objective.

More recently, Alonso-Pecina et al. (2024) proposed an ILS for a multiple-source inventory-routing application in which operating cost is divided by total delivered quantity. Man et al. (2025) extended logistics-ratio optimisation to a multi-product setting with lateral transshipment and uncertain demand.

Recent developments for conventional cost-based IRPs are also methodologically relevant. Castro et al. (2026) developed a Hybrid Genetic Search (HGS) that combines population-based search, specialised neighbourhoods, and an inventory-flow optimisation procedure. Zhao et al. (2025) proposed a large neighbourhood within HGS that jointly changes visit periods, routing insertions, and delivery quantities across the planning horizon. Their work also considers controlled inventory infeasibility through penalised stockouts. Although these recent HGS approaches do not optimise the same logistic-ratio formulation considered here, they highlight the potential benefits of coupling powerful route exploration with specialised quantity optimisation and of allowing controlled infeasibility during the search.

Table 1: Selected literature relevant to the IRP-LR and the proposed solution methodology.

Study	**Problem / objective**	**Solution approach**	**Key search characteristic**	**Relevance**
Archetti et al. (2017b)	IRP; routing cost / quantity delivered	Exact fractional optimisation	Joint routing and replenishment optimisation	Introduces and analyses the IRP-LR
Alvarez et al. (2018)	IRP including logistic-ratio objective	ILS and Simulated Annealing	Neighbourhood-based routing and replenishment search	Direct metaheuristic precedent for IRP-LR
Archetti et al. (2019)	IRP-LR	Iterative exact method	Sequence of IRPs with modified linear objectives	Main exact IRP-LR methodology
Absi et al. (2020)	Rich IRP; unit distribution cost	Heuristic branch-cut-and-price	Integrated routing, quantity and scheduling optimisation	Large-scale fractional industrial IRP
Su et al. (2020)	ROADEF/EURO IRP	Local search with MIP/LP	Mathematical programming improves timing and quantities	Relevant hybrid local-search approach
He et al. (2020)	ROADEF/EURO IRP	Fixed-sequence matheuristic	Reoptimises quantities and timing for fixed visit sequences	Closest precedent for route-fixed quantity optimisation
Baldacci et al. (2020)	Fractional VRP	Exact fractional-routing method	Primal and dual bounding procedures	General fractional-routing methodology
Alonso-Pecina et al. (2024)	Operating cost / quantity delivered	Iterated Local Search	Realistic inventory-routing neighbourhood search	Recent ILS with a ratio objective
Man et al. (2025)	Multi-product logistics-ratio IRP	Robust fractional optimisation	Uncertainty and lateral transshipment	Recent extension of logistics-ratio optimisation
Castro et al. (2026)	Conventional IRP	Hybrid Genetic Search	Route search combined with inventory-flow optimisation	Recent high-performance IRP search framework
Zhao et al. (2025)	Conventional and stockout-penalised IRP	HGS and large-neighbourhood search	Cross-period route/quantity optimisation and controlled infeasibility	Highly relevant search-design principles

3.3 Lagrangian-Relaxed Problem

The literature suggests two particularly useful principles for difficult IRPs: delivery quantities should be reconsidered jointly with the route structure, and restricting the search to feasible solutions can limit the ability to move between substantially different replenishment plans. The proposed algorithm exploits both ideas.

In the original formulation, Constraint (7), together with $\mu_{it} \geq 0$, forces all stockout variables to zero. To allow the search to temporarily explore inventory-infeasible solutions, we dualise Constraint (7) using a Lagrange multiplier $\alpha \geq 0$. Following the general principle of Lagrangian relaxation (Fisher, 1981), the resulting relaxed objective is

$$\min \quad \frac{\sum_{k \in K} \sum_{\langle i,j \rangle \in E} \sum_{t \in T} c_{ij} y_{ij}^{kt}}{\sum_{k \in K} \sum_{i \in N'} \sum_{t \in T} q_{it}^{k}} + \alpha \sum_{i \in N'} \sum_{t \in T} \mu_{it}. \tag{17}$$

The relaxed problem consists of objective (17) subject to

$$(3) - -(6), \qquad (8) - -(16),$$

that is, Constraint (7) is removed. The variables μ_{it} can therefore take positive values and quantify inventory shortages, which are penalised through the multiplier α.

A small value of α allows the search to explore solutions with larger stockout violations when this facilitates improvements in routing and replenishment structure, whereas a larger value increasingly discourages such violations and directs the search towards the feasible region. Thus, the relaxed formulation provides a mechanism for controlled exploration of both feasible and infeasible regions of the solution space.

In what follows, formulation (2)–(16) is referred to as the *original problem*, while (17) together with the remaining constraints is referred to as the *relaxed problem*. The proposed MSILS algorithm uses the relaxed problem during local search and dynamically adjusts the multiplier α, as described in Section 4.

4 Description of the Algorithm

This section describes the proposed Multi-Start Iterated Local Search (MSILS) algorithm for solving the Inventory Routing Problem with Logistic Ratio (IRP-LR). The algorithm uses features that include a mechanism for delivery quantity adjustment, delivery quantity-focused local search operators, and exploring infeasible regions through the amalgamation of iterated local search and Lagrangian relaxation. The remainder of this section is organised as follows. Section 4.1 presents the overall MSILS framework. Section 4.2 describes the

constructive heuristic used to generate the initial solutions. Section 4.3 provides the details on the local search procedure for solving the relaxed problem. Section 4.4 introduces a quantity-focused rebalancing procedure that attempts to improve total delivery quantity while preserving route schedules. Finally, Section 4.5 describes the perturbation mechanism used to diversify the search and escape local optima.

4.1 Main algorithm

Let s denote a solution, which may be infeasible for the original problem (2)-(16). For each customer $i \in N'$, each time period $t \in T$, and each vehicle $k \in K$, part of the solution s is characterised by $q_{it}^k(s)$, $I_{it}(s)$, and $\mu_{it}(s)$, where

- $q_{it}^k(s) \geq 0$ is the delivery quantity by vehicle k, to customer i in time period t;
- $I_{0t}(s) \geq 0$ is the inventory level at the depot in time period t;
- $I_{it}(s) \geq 0$ is the inventory level at customer i in time period t; and
- $\mu_{it}(s) \geq 0$ is the stockout amount at customer i in time period t.

If customer i is visited by vehicle k in time t, $q_{it}^k(s)$ is positive; zero otherwise. The net inventory level is defined as $I_{it}(s) - \mu_{it}(s)$ and is computed recursively according to

$$I_{i,1}(s) - \mu_{i,1}(s) = I_{i,0} - r_{i,1} + \sum_{k \in K} q_{i1}^k(s), \tag{18}$$

$$I_{i,t}(s) - \mu_{i,t}(s) = I_{i,t-1}(s) - \mu_{i,t-1}(s) - r_{i,t} + \sum_{k \in K} q_{it}^k(s),\ 2 \leq t \leq |T|. \tag{19}$$

The inventory level of the depot is computed by

$$I_{0,1}(s) = I_{0,0} + r_{0,1} - \sum_{i \in N'} \sum_{k \in K} q_{i1}^k(s), \tag{20}$$

$$I_{0,t}(s) = I_{0,t-1}(s) + r_{0,t} - \sum_{i \in N'} \sum_{k \in K} q_{it}^k(s),\ 2 \leq t \leq |T|. \tag{21}$$

If s is feasible to the relaxed problem and has $\sum_{i \in N'} \sum_{i \in T} \mu_{it}(s) = 0$, then s is also feasible for the original problem. The value of s on the objective function (2) is denoted by $f(s)$, and the value on the objective function (17) with Lagrange multiplier α is denoted by $f_\mu(s, \alpha)$. The following pseudocode outlines the proposed MSILS.

Algorithm 1 MSILS

1: $s^* \leftarrow \emptyset$, $f(s^*) \leftarrow +\infty$
2: **for** $i \leftarrow 1$ **to** $Max_{restart}$ **do**
3: $s \leftarrow$Initial_Solution_Procedure, $\hat{s} \leftarrow s$, $it \leftarrow 0$
4: **if** $f(s) < f(s^*)$ **then**
5: $s^* \leftarrow s$
6: **end if**
7: **while** $it < |N'| + \sigma|T| + \phi|K|$ **do**
8: $\alpha \leftarrow \epsilon(s^*, s, 0, \eta)$, $\bar{s} \leftarrow s$, $s \leftarrow$Local_Search(s, α)
9: **while** $f_\mu(s, \alpha) \neq f_\mu(\bar{s}, \alpha)$ **or** s has stockout **do**
10: $\alpha \leftarrow \epsilon(s^*, s, \alpha, \eta)$, $\bar{s} \leftarrow s$, $s \leftarrow$Local_Search(s, α)
11: **end while**
12: **if** s is feasible **and** $f(s) < f(\hat{s})$ **then**
13: $\hat{s} \leftarrow s$, $it \leftarrow 0$, $\hat{s} \leftarrow$Rebalance$(\hat{s})$
14: **end if**
15: **if** $\hat{s}$ is feasible **and** $f(\hat{s}) < f(s^*)$ **then**
16: $s^* \leftarrow \hat{s}$
17: **end if**
18: $s \leftarrow$ Disturbance$(\hat{s}, it)$, $it \leftarrow it + 1$
19: **end while**
20: **end for**
21: **return** s^*

Initially, the global best-known solution s^* is empty, and $f(s^*)$ is set to $+\infty$ (line 1). s^* is updated throughout the algorithm. The FOR loop (lines 2-20) implements the multi-start framework. At each restart, a feasible solution to the original problem is generated using the constructive heuristic described in 4.2. This solution is used as the starting solution for the upcoming application of the iterated local search (WHILE loop, lines 7-19). By repeatedly restarting the iterated local search from different initial solutions, the algorithm can explore diversified regions of the solution space. The number of starting solutions is controlled by the parameter $Max_{restart}$.

Each application of the iterated local search uses a local search procedure to solve a sequence of relaxed problems, each with a different value of α. If an optimal solution $\tilde{s}$ for the relaxed problem can be obtained, then following a commonly used version of the Lagrangian relaxation method Fisher (1981), α is computed by

$$\alpha + \frac{\eta \times (f(s^*) - f_\mu(\tilde{s}, \alpha)) \times (\sum_{i \in N'} \sum_{t \in T} \mu_{it}(\tilde{s}))}{\left(\sum_{i \in N'} \sum_{t \in T} \mu_{it}(\tilde{s})\right)^2} \tag{22}$$

where η is a scalar. Since the local search cannot guarantee the optimal solution $\tilde{s}$, instead of (22), α is computed by

$$\epsilon(s^*, s, \alpha, \eta) = \alpha + \frac{\eta \times \delta \times (\sum_{i \in N'} \sum_{t \in T} \mu_{it}(s) + 0.001)}{\left(\sum_{i \in N'} \sum_{t \in T} \mu_{it}(s)\right)^2 + 0.00001} \tag{23}$$

where

$$\delta = \begin{cases} f(s^*) - f_\mu(s,\alpha) & \text{if } f(s^*) - f_\mu(s,\alpha) > 0; \\ 0.1 \times f(s^*) & \text{Otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Once local search obtains a feasible solution for the original problem, $\epsilon(\cdot)$ becomes just

$$\alpha + \frac{\eta \times \delta \times (0.001)}{0.00001}$$

which greedily increases α until the stopping criterion is satisfied for the WHILE loop (lines 9-11). The initial value of α is computed by $\epsilon(s^*, s, 0, \eta)$ in line 8 and the subsequent values is computed by $\epsilon(s^*, s, \alpha, \eta)$ in line 10 using α from the previous call of the local search procedure.

To escape from the local optimum, the MSILS begins with a quantity-focused disturbance procedure, referred to as the rebalance procedure. This procedure attempts to further improve the locally best-known solution $\hat{s}$ by adjusting the delivery quantities, keeping the schedule fixed (see Section 4.4). The output of the procedure is either the input, meaning that the procedure failed to make any improvement or a feasible solution of the original problem with a lower logistic ratio. To limit computational overhead, the rebalance procedure is invoked only when $\hat{s}$ has been improved. To further diversify the search, the MSILS applies a route-focused disturbance procedure on $\hat{s}$, generating the starting solution for the subsequent call of local search. The iterated local search (WHILE loop lines 7-19) terminates after the counter it reaches $|N'| + \sigma|T| + \phi|K|$, the maximum permissible number of consecutive iterations without improvement, where σ and ϕ are the weight parameters on the number of time periods and the number of vehicles, respectively.

4.2 Initial feasible solution

This section describes the heuristic to construct the initial solution for the MSILS. It aims to produce a good feasible solution to the original problem (2)-(16), thereby establishing the initial upper bound.

The solution s is initialised with empty routes and zero delivery quantities, $q_{it}^k(s) = 0$ for $i \in N'$, $k \in K$, and $t \in T$. The net inventory levels $I_{it}(s) - \mu_{it}(s)$ are calculated by (20) and (21) accordingly. The customers are grouped by the earliest time period in which their net inventory levels become negative. Those customers with earlier stockouts are given higher priority. Within each stockout group, customers are further partitioned spatially. Let (x_i, y_i) denote the coordinates of location $i \in N$. Using the coordinate minima and maxima

$$x_{\min} = \min_{i \in N} x_i, \quad x_{\max} = \max_{i \in N} x_i,$$

$$y_{\min} = \min_{i \in N} y_i, \quad y_{\max} = \max_{i \in N} y_i,$$

an axis-aligned bounding rectangle is defined with corners (x_{min}, y_{min}), (x_{max}, y_{min}), (x_{max}, y_{max}), and (x_{min}, y_{max}). The resulting axis-aligned rectangle is divided

into a $d \times d$ grid of subregions $R = \{r_1, r_2, \ldots, r_{d \times d}\}$ where d is randomly selected between the minimum possible grid resolution d_{min} and the maximum possible grid resolution $d_{\max}$.

Observe that, during the early stages of the solution construction, vehicles typically have sufficient capacity to deliver the largest possible quantities respecting both vehicle and inventory capacity constraints. Such flexibility reduces as the construction goes on, and customers who will be considered at a later stage often require more visits. Thus, the subregions are ordered by decreasing distance from their centres to the depot, so customers in more distant subregions are processed earlier.

For each stockout group and subregion, the heuristic randomly selects a customer and repeatedly schedules a visit to address that customer's earliest remaining stockout. It first searches for an unoccupied period between the current search period and the stockout period that has remaining fleet capacity, choosing randomly among available periods. If none is available, it searches backwards for an earlier period. In the selected period, it assigns the customer to the vehicle that can accommodate the largest delivery, with the quantity limited by that vehicle's residual capacity and the customer's remaining inventory capacity. It then updates the customer's inventory trajectory and continues until no customer stockout remains. If a customer faces stockout even when the customer is visited in every period, then no feasible schedule exists for that customer. In this case, the instance is infeasible. The procedure returns an empty solution, and the MSILS is terminated.

Let $P_{t,r} \subseteq N'$ denote the subset of customers in priority group $t \in T$ and subregion $r \in R$. The pseudocode, Construct Initial Solution, summarises the procedure.

Construct Initial Solution

initialise solution s
partition customers by priority and distance to depot
for $t \in T$ **and** $r \in R$ **do**
  while $P_{t,r} \neq [\,]$ **do**
    randomly choose a customer i from $P_{t,r}$
    $t_{current} \leftarrow 1$
    while $\{\hat{t} \in T : I_{i,\hat{t}}(s) - \mu_{i,\hat{t}}(s) < 0\} \neq [\,]$ **do**
      $t_{stockout} \leftarrow \min\{t \in T : I_{i,t}(s) - \mu_{i,t}(s) < 0\}$
      $t_{assign} \leftarrow$ Find Feasible Visit Time $(t_{current}, t_{stockout}, i)$
      $(k, q) \leftarrow$ Find Vehicle To Deliver Max(t_{assign}, i, s)
      $q^k_{i,t_{assign}} \leftarrow q$
      add customer i to vehicle k's route on time period t_{assign}
      for all $t' \in T$, update $I_{i,t'}(s) - \mu_{it'}(s)$ according to (20) and (21)
      $t_{current} \leftarrow t_{assign} + 1$
    end while
    $P_{t,r} \leftarrow P_{t,r} \setminus i$
  end while
end for
$s \leftarrow$nearest_neighbour_insertion(s)
return s

After the schedule has been constructed, a nearest-neighbour insertion Bräysy and Gendreau (2005) is applied independently to each vehicle's route in each period. It starts with the customer nearest to the depot. At each subsequent step, it selects the unvisited customer closest to the current tour and inserts that customer in the position that yields the smallest increase in the length of the closed route. The resulting solution is then returned to MSILS.

4.3 Local search

The local search uses five neighbourhood operators, denoted by O_1, O_2, O_3, O_4, and O_5. These operators are based on those commonly found in the field of vehicle routing (see, for example, Kindervater and Savelsbergh (1997), Laporte et al. (2000), and Elshaer and Awad (2020)) and are also frequently used in the field of inventory routing (see, for example, Alvarez et al. (2018), Laganà et al. (2024), and Castro et al. (2026)). Each operator defines a neighbourhood through a set of alterations. Each alteration transforms the input solution into a neighbouring solution by modifying one or more of its components.

Rather than employing separate operators for route alterations and delivery quantity alterations, the operators O_1, O_2, O_3, and O_4 integrate both into a single alteration. Such an integration enables the exploration of the logistic ratio, i.e., the simultaneous exploration of total transportation cost and total delivery quantity. The routing component of these operators is described as follows:

- Operator O_1 moves up to 3 adjacent customers from a route to another in the same period.
- Operator O_2 exchanges up to 2 adjacent customers in a route with up to 2 adjacent customers in another route in the same period.
- Operator O_3 transfers a customer visit to a different time period in which this customer is not visited, with the vehicle giving the largest possible delivery quantity at a position with the lowest in transportation cost.
- Operator O_4 exchanges a customer in a route with one unvisited customer, including the case where either a visited customer becomes unvisited or an unvisited customer becomes visited.

For an alteration that results in removing the visit to customer $i \in N'$ at time $t \in T$ on vehicle $k \in K$, the associated $q_{it}^k(s)$ becomes 0. For an alteration that results in a new visit to customer $i \in N'$ at time $t \in T$ on vehicle $k \in K$, the associated $q_{it}^k(s)$ is computed by

$$q_{jt}^k = \max\{0, \min\{Q - \sum_{i \in N'} q_{it}^k(s), U_i - I\}\} \tag{24}$$

where

$$I = \begin{cases} I_{i,0} & \text{if } t = 1; \\ I_{i,t-1}(s) & \text{if } 2 \leq t \leq |T| \end{cases}$$

Please note that $\max\{0, \cdot\}$ is required since the local search allows the violation of stockout where I can be negative and $U_i - I$ can also be negative. For customer i, the resulting inventory level is updated recursively according to (20) and (21). These updated inventory levels may affect the subsequent deliveries. Therefore, following the update in each time period, if the customer is visited in the subsequent time period, the delivery quantity for that visit is adjusted using (24).

For the last operator, Operator O_5 is a pure routing operator. It transfers up to 3 adjacent customers from their current position to another position in the same route. In contrast to operators O_1, O_2, O_3, and O_4, the alterations associated with operator O_5 do not affect the delivery quantities and the inventory levels.

The local search procedure implements a sequential variable neighbourhood descent procedure for solving the relaxed problem. For a given solution s and the Lagrange multiplier α, the neighbourhoods induced by operators O_1 to O_5 are explored successively. Within a neighbourhood associated with Operator $i \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$, all neighbouring solutions denoted by $O_i(s)$ are evaluated according to the objective function $f_\mu(\cdot, \alpha)$, and the current solution is updated whenever an improving neighbour is identified. The neighbourhood is repeatedly re-explored until no improving solution can be found, thereby ensuring local optimality with respect to the corresponding operator. The search then proceeds to the next operator. The procedure terminates once all five operators have

Local Search(s, α)

```
for i ← 0; i ≤ 5; i ← i + 1 do
  repeat
    ŝ ← s, j ← 1
    while j < |O_i(s)| do
      s' ← s_j ∈ O^i(s), j ← j + 1
      if f_μ(s', α) < f_μ(s, α) then
        s ← s'
      end if
    end while
  until f_μ(s, α) = f_μ(ŝ, α)
end for
s ← remove any visit with zero delivery quantity
return s
```

been exhausted without improvement, at which point any visits associated with zero delivery quantity are removed and the resulting solution is returned. The pseudocode, Local Search summaries the local search procedure.

4.4 Rebalance Procedure

The local search procedure simultaneously explores routing decisions and delivery quantities. However, the improved solution may still contain delivery quantities that are not fully consistent with the fixed schedule. In particular, some customer visits may carry quantities that are unnecessarily large, whereas other visits may have unused inventory or vehicle capacity that could be exploited to increase the total delivery quantity. Since the objective of the IRP-LR is expressed as the ratio between routing cost and delivery quantity, improving the quantity allocation alone can further improve the objective value even when the routing schedule remains unchanged. This section describes the rebalance procedure, which exploits such an opportunity whenever a new incumbent solution s^* is obtained.

The procedure consists of two phases. First, delivery quantities are partially removed from existing visits whenever such reductions do not create stockouts. This releases inventory and vehicle capacity that may have been inefficiently allocated. Second, the released quantities are reallocated among the existing visits. Customers are selected randomly, favouring customers with low inventory levels, high demand rates, long intervals until their next visits, and infrequent replenishment patterns. For each selected customer, the maximum feasible quantity is assigned while respecting inventory capacity and vehicle capacity. The inventory level is then updated, and visits associated with zero delivery quantity are subsequently removed.

By combining quantity reallocation with randomised customer selection, the rebalance procedure not only intensifies the search for better delivery quantities

around a promising routing schedule but also introduces diversification, enabling the algorithm to escape local optima in the quantity domain. The pseudocode below summarises the rebalance procedure.

Algorithm 4 Rebalance(s^*)

$s \leftarrow s^*$
for $i \leftarrow 1$ **to** $|N'|$ **do**
  for $t \leftarrow 1$ **to** $|T|$ **do**
    if customer i is visited on day t **then**
      Quantity ← Quantity - Feasible_Quantity_To_Removal(i, t)
      Update inventory levels for all subsequent days
    end if
  end for
end for
$s \leftarrow$Assign_max_possible_quantity_after_feasible(s)
$s \leftarrow$Remove visits with zero delivery quantities
return s

In addition to the rebalance procedure described above, an alternative Destory_And_Rebalance procedure was developed. This variant first removes all delivery quantities and then reconstructs them while keeping the routing schedule fixed. Because the reconstruction does not guarantee feasibility, a repair mechanism is subsequently applied to eliminate stockouts whenever possible. The larger perturbation induced by this procedure promotes diversification and allows the search to explore quantity allocations that are less accessible through the former rebalance procedure. The pseudocode for this variant is presented in Appendix D. Both rebalance procedures are examined in the computation experiments.

4.5 Perturbation

The perturbation procedure is a diversification mechanism designed to help the MSILS escape local optima. It randomly removes two or more adjacent customers from a route together with their associated delivery quantities, after which inventory levels and subsequent deliveries are updated accordingly. The number of removals is determined by $1 + \lfloor \frac{\theta \times it}{Max_{it}} \rfloor$, where it is the number of consecutive non-improving iterations, Max_{it} is the maximum number of consecutive non-improving iterations allowed, and θ is a parameter handling the disturbance strength. Hence, the perturbation strength increases progressively as it increases. This adaptive strategy allows the algorithm to balance intensification and diversification by exploring increasingly distant regions of the solution space when improvements become difficult to obtain. The resulting perturbed solution serves as the starting point for the next local search iteration. Since the removals typically induce stockouts, the perturbed solution is generally infeasible for the original problem. However, allowing such infeasibility enables the search to traverse infeasible regions of the solution space and

escape deep local optima. Feasibility is subsequently restored during the local search.

5 Computational experiments

This section describes the computational experiments conducted to evaluate the performance of the proposed MSILS. The algorithm is implemented in C++, and all experiments were conducted on a computer with an Intel Core i7-1185G7 3.00 GHz CPU and 16GB RAM. The rest of the section is structured as follows. The test instances used for the computation experiments are summarised in Section 5.1. Section 5.3 discusses the parameter settings and demonstrates the performance gain from different components used in the MSILS. Section 5.4 evaluates the MSILS by comparing its performance with the performance of the ILS and SA algorithms proposed by Alvarez et al. (2018). This section also evaluates the performance gain from integrating the Hybrid Genetic Search (HGS) framework of Vidal (2022) into MSILS.

5.1 Test instances

To evaluate the proposed MSILS, computational experiments were conducted on benchmark instances originating from Archetti et al. (2007), Archetti et al. (2012), and the 12th DIMACS Implementation Challenge for the multi-vehicle IRP. These instances have been widely used in the IRP literature, including Archetti et al. (2012); Coelho and Laporte (2013); Desaulniers et al. (2016); Santos et al. (2016); Archetti et al. (2017b); Alvarez et al. (2018); Archetti et al. (2019); Castro et al. (2026).

The benchmark introduced by Archetti et al. (2007) contains a set of single-vehicle IRP instances comprising 50 instances ranging from 5 to 50 customers for a planning horizon of 3 time periods, and 30 instances ranging from 5 to 30 customers for a planning horizon of 6 time periods. Each instance is available under two inventory-cost scenarios (high and low), resulting in a total of 160 instances. These single-vehicle IRP instances were extended to multi-vehicle versions with a number of vehicles ranging from 2 to 5, creating an additional 640 instances. Following Alvarez et al. (2018) and the DIMACS Implementation Challenge, the vehicle capacities for the multi-vehicle IRP instances were obtained by dividing the vehicle capacity in the corresponding single-vehicle instances by the number of vehicles and rounding down to the nearest lower integer.

The 12th DIMACS Implementation Challenge further introduced 160 additional multi-vehicle instances with a number of customers ranging from 35 to 50, completing the 6-time-period planning horizon dataset. In addition, the single- and multi-vehicle IRP instances for 3 planning horizons were extended to a planning horizon of 4 and 5 periods in Archetti et al. (2017b). This was done by increasing the planning horizons from 3 to 4 and 5, resulting in another 1000 instances. Collectively, these datasets comprise 1960 instances covering 5

to 50 customers, 3 to 6 planning horizons, 1 to 5 vehicles, and two inventory-cost settings.

A larger scale of the benchmark was also considered. In Archetti et al. (2012), a set of 60 single-vehicle IRP instances was introduced with a number of customers ranging from 50 to 200. These instances were also extended to multi-vehicle instances, resulting in a total of 300 instances. The single-vehicle IRP instances from Archetti et al. (2007) and Archetti et al. (2012) can be downloaded from Single-vehicle IRP instances and the instances for the 12th DIMACS Implementation Challenge for the multi-vehicle IRP can be downloaded from DIMACS Inventory Routing Challenge.

For the above-mentioned instances, the distance c_{ij} between each node $i \in N$ and $j \in N$ is calculated and rounded to the nearest integer by

$$\left\lfloor \sqrt{(x_i - x_j)^2 + (y_i - y_j)^2} + \frac{1}{2} \right\rfloor$$

, where x_i, x_j, y_i, y_j are the x- and y-coordinates for nodes i and j. Since the IRP-LR does not include inventory cost, only one inventory-cost setting was retained, and inventory-cost information was discarded. Consequently, the final test bed consists of 980 instances for 5 to 50 customers and 150 instances for 50 to 200 customers.

Also noting, two instances were excluded from the study due to infeasibility. The instance "abs5n5_5" with 6 periods and 5 vehicles is a known infeasible instance Alvarez et al. (2018). In addition, the preliminary experiments revealed that the instance "abs4n5_5" with 5 planning periods and 5 vehicles is also infeasible, as stockouts occur even when a certain customer is visited in every period.

For reproducibility, all benchmark instances used in the computational experiments are publicly available at `https://github.com/AndyElhamSarang/IRP_instances.git`.

5.2 Parameter calibrations

The parameters for the MSILS are set to the values listed in Table 2. These values were determined from preliminary experiments.

Table 3: Variants derived from MSILS

Variants	Description
MSILS	Full algorithm described in Section 4.
$\not{R}$	Deactivating the Rebalance Procedure at line 13 in MSILS.
$D\&R$	Instead of using the Rebalance Procedure described in Section 4.4, line 13 uses the Destory_And_Rebalance procedure described in Appendix D
$\not{D}$	Deactivating the First-stage DISTURB from the procedure Perturbation.
MSILS-HGS	MSILS with HGS, with the time required for the HGS excluded from the time limit.
MSILS-Initial-Alt	Use constructive heuristics in Alvarez et al. (2018) to construct the initial feasible solution.

Table 2: Default values of parameters

Parameters	Definition	Tested Range
$d_{\min}$	Minimum grid resolution in initial solution construction	$\{1, \underline{\mathbf{2}}, 3, 4, 5\}$
$d_{\max}$	Maximum grid resolution in initial solution construction	$\{2, \underline{\mathbf{3}}, 4, 7\}$
$Max_{restart}$	Number of initial starting solutions	{1,**3**,5,10,20} {3,4,**5**,6,7,8,9}
η	Scalor for updating the Lagrange multiplier α	{ 1,3,**5**,10,20,100000}
σ	Weight parameters on number of time periods to compute the maximum permissible number of consecutive iterations without improvement from the ILS	{ 5,7,**10**,15,20}{**1**,2,3,4,5,6,8,10,12}
ϕ	Weight parameters on number of vehicles to compute the maximum permissible number of consecutive iterations without improvement from the ILS	{ 5,6,7,**8**,9,10,15,20}{8,**9**,10,11,12}
θ	Disturbance strength	{1,**2**,4,5,7,9,10}

5.3 Impact on the performance of individual mechanisms in MSILS and parameter tuning

The proposed MSILS has several key components, including an application of the Lagrangian relaxation technique, the rebalance procedure, and the disturbance procedure. This section examines the performance gain from utilising each of these components. Four variants have been derived from the MSILS. Each variant deactivates or modifies a specific component. Table 3 summarises each variant.

The variant $\not{L}$ is used to examine the performance gain of using the Lagrangian relaxation technique. By initialising α to a large value, the Local_Search procedure would just repair the infeasible starting solution. Thereafter, due to

the high penalty for stockout, the search process would remain in the feasible solution space. All four variants and the MSILS were tested on Archettie2012 benchmark. Each version of the algorithm was given a time limit of 1 minute.

5.4 Performance evaluation

Compared with the supplementary results from Alvarez et al. (2018) available at https://www.dep.ufscar.br/munari/irp/.

The proposed MSILS is compared with ILS and SA in Alvarez et al. (2018). The algorithm is validated in small instances by comparing the optimal solutions obtained by the ACS algorithm developed in Archetti et al. (2019).

Table 4: Average percentage gap (%) of MSILS compared with ILS

	$\|T\| = 2$	$\|T\| = 3$	$\|T\| = 4$	$\|T\| = 5$	Average
$\|N'\| = 50$	-8.00	-4.30	-5.03	-5.13	-5.61
$\|N'\| = 100$	-8.63	-6.59	-6.57	-6.90	-7.17
$\|N'\| = 200$	-9.02	-6.16	-5.16	-4.10	-6.11
Average	-8.55	-5.68	-5.58	-5.38	-6.30

Table 5: Average percentage gap (%) of MSILS compared with SA

	$\|T\| = 2$	$\|T\| = 3$	$\|T\| = 4$	$\|T\| = 5$	Average
$\|N'\| = 50$	-7.59	-5.28	-4.82	-4.97	-5.67
$\|N'\| = 100$	-10.00	-6.66	-7.56	-6.16	-7.59
$\|N'\| = 200$	-15.59	-10.18	-9.77	-7.40	-10.73
Average	-11.06	-7.37	-7.38	-6.18	-8.00

5.5 Robustness

A Functions used to construct initial solution

Find Feasible Visit Time($t_{current}$, $t_{Stockout}$, i)

while true **do**
  if $t_{current} \leq t_{Stockout}$ **then**
    // **schedule forward**//
    $T_{candidate} \leftarrow \{t \in T : t_{current} \leq t \leq t_{stockout},$
      customer i is not visited at t,
      $Q \times |K| - \sum_{k \in K} \sum_{i \in N'} q^k_{i,t}(s) > 0\}$
    if $T_{candidate} \neq [\,]$ **then**
      return $t \sim$ RANDOM($T_{candidate}$)
    else
      $t_{current} \leftarrow t_{Stockout} + 1$
    end if
  else
    // **schedule backward**//
    for $t \leftarrow t_{stockout}; t \geq 1; t \leftarrow t - 1$ **do**
      if customer i is not visited at time period t **then**
        if $Q \times |K| - \sum_{k \in K} \sum_{i \in N'} q^k_{i,t}(s) > 0$ **then**
          return t
        end if
      end if
    end for
  end if
end while

Find Vehicle To Deliver Max(t, i, s)

$k' \leftarrow |K| + 1$, $q' \leftarrow 0$,
for $k \in K$ **do**
  $q \leftarrow 0$
  if $t = 1$ **then**
    $q \leftarrow min\{Q - \sum_{j \in N'} q^k_{j,1}(s), U_i - I_{i,0}\}$
  else
    $q \leftarrow min\{Q - \sum_{j \in N'} q^k_{j,t}(s), U_i - I_{i,t-1}(s)\}$
  end if
  if $q' < q$ **then**
    $q' \leftarrow q$, $k' \leftarrow k$
  end if
end for
return k', q'

B MSILS with HGS

Algorithm 7 MSILS with HGS in Vidal (2022)

$s^* \leftarrow$ Empty **and** $f(s^*) \leftarrow +\infty$
for $i \leftarrow 1$ **to** $Max_{restart}$ **do**
  $s \leftarrow$ Construct initial solution
  $s \leftarrow HGS(s)$ {to improve routing}
  if $f(s) < f(s^*)$ **then**
    $s^* \leftarrow s$
  end if
  Run_HGS_Or_Not $\leftarrow$ FALSE
  $it \leftarrow 0$, $\eta \leftarrow \eta'$, $u \leftarrow 0$
  while $it < Max_{it}$ **do**
    $\alpha \leftarrow \epsilon(s^*, s, 0, \eta)$
    $\bar{s} \leftarrow s$
    $s \leftarrow$ Local_Search(s, α)
    while $f_\mu(s, \alpha) \neq f_\mu(\bar{s}, \alpha)$ **do**
      $\alpha \leftarrow \epsilon(s^*, s, \alpha, \eta)$
      $\bar{s} \leftarrow s$
      $s \leftarrow$Local_Search(s, α)
    end while
    if $min\{it, u\} \geq U$ **then**
      $u \leftarrow 0$, $\eta \leftarrow \kappa \times \eta$
    end if
    if s is feasible **and** $f(s) < f(s^*)$ **then**
      $s^* \leftarrow s$, $it \leftarrow 0$
      $s^* \leftarrow$ Rebalance(s^*)
      Run_HGS_Or_Not $\leftarrow$ TRUE
    end if
    $s \leftarrow$ Disturbance(s^*, it), $it \leftarrow it + 1$, $u \leftarrow u + 1$
  end while
  if Run_HGS_Or_Not = TRUE **then**
    $s^* \leftarrow HGS(s^*)$
  end if
end for
return solution s^*

C Functions used in Rebalance procedure guarantee feasible solution

Algorithm 8 Feasible_Quantity_To_Removal(i, j)

Quantity_To_Remove $\leftarrow min\{I_{i,j}, q_{i,j}\}$
$I \leftarrow I_{i,j-1}+q_{i,j}-r_{i,j}-$Quantity_To_Remove {New inventory level of period j}
Stockout $\leftarrow 0$
for $time \leftarrow j$ **to** $|T|$ **do**
  $I \leftarrow I_{i,time} + q_{i,j} - r_{i,j}$
  if Stockout $\leq -I'$ **then**
    Stockout $\leftarrow -I'$
  end if
end for
return $\leftarrow max\{0, Quantity - Stockout\}$

Algorithm 9 Assign_max_possible_quantity_after_feasible(s)

for $i \leftarrow 1$ **to** $|T|$ **do**
  PRIORITY $\leftarrow \emptyset$
  for $j \leftarrow 1$ **to** $|N'|$ **do**
    if customer j is visited on day i **then**
      Add customer j to PRIORITY with computed priority value
    end if
  end for
  while PRIORITY is not empty **do**
    Select a customer randomly according to PRIORITY weights
    Deliver the maximum feasible quantity to the selected customer
    Remove the selected customer from PRIORITY
    Update inventory levels and delivery quantity for subsequent days
  end while
end for
return s

D Rebalance procedure without guarantee feasible solution

Algorithm 10 Destory_And_Rebalance(s^*)

$s \leftarrow s^*$
Set all delivery quantities in s to zero
Update inventory levels in s
for $i \leftarrow 1$ **to** $|T|$ **do**
  for $j \leftarrow 1$ **to** $|N'|$ **do**
    if customer j is visited on day i **then**
      Quantity $\leftarrow$ Find_max_quantity_avoid_stockout(j, i)
      Assign Quantity
      Update inventory levels for all subsequent days
    end if
  end for
end for
Stockout_resolved $\leftarrow$ FALSE
$\{s, Stockout_resolved\} \leftarrow$Repair$(s, Stockout_resolved)$
if Stock_resolved = FALSE **then**
  return s
end if
$s \leftarrow$Assign_max_possible_quantity_after_feasible(s)
Remove visits with zero delivery quantities
return s

Algorithm 11 Find_max_quantity_avoid_stockout($customer, time$)

Quantity $\leftarrow 0$
Quantity $\leftarrow$ Find_max_stockout$(customer, time)$
Quantity $\leftarrow \min\{Quantity, U_{customer} - \max\{I_{customer,time-1}, 0\}\}$ {If stockout occurs in the previous period, assumes the inventory level is 0.}
Quantity $\leftarrow \min\{Quantity, Q - Vehicle_load\}$
return Quantity

Algorithm 12 Find_max_stockout$(customer, time)$

1: Largest_stockout $\leftarrow 0$
2: **for** $t \leftarrow time$ **to** $|T|$ **do**
3: **if** Largest_stokout $> I_{customer,t}$ **then**
4: Largest_stockout $\leftarrow I_{customer,t}$
5: **end if**
6: **end for**
7: Largest_stockout $\leftarrow -Largest_stockout$
8: **return** Largest_stockout

Algorithm 13 Repair$(s, Stockout_resolved)$

```
Possible_repair ← TRUE
while Stockout_resolved = FALSE and Possible_repair = TRUE do
  Stockout_resolved ← TRUE
  Possible_repair ← FALSE
  for i ← 1 to |T| do
    for j ← 1 to |N'| do
      if customer j has stockout at time i then
        Stockout_resolved ← FALSE
        Quantity_stockout ← I_{j,i}
        for k ← 1 to time i do
          if Customer j is visited in time k then
            for customer z ∈ N' are visited by the same vehicle do
              if Some quantity, Δ associated with customer z can be removed then
                for x ← 1 to |T| do
                  if customer z is visited on time x then
                    if Δ can be delivered on time x to customer z without stockout then
                      Possible_repair ← TRUE
                      Quantity_Δ ← min{Quantity_stockout, Δ}
                      Remove Quantity_Δ from visiting customer z on time k
                      Deliver extra Quantity_Δ unit on day x
                      Deliver Quantity_Δ unit for customer j on time k
                      Update delivery quantity and inventory level
                    end if
                  end if
                end for
              end if
            end for
          end if
        end for
      end if
    end for
  end for
end while
return {s, Stockout_resolved}
```

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